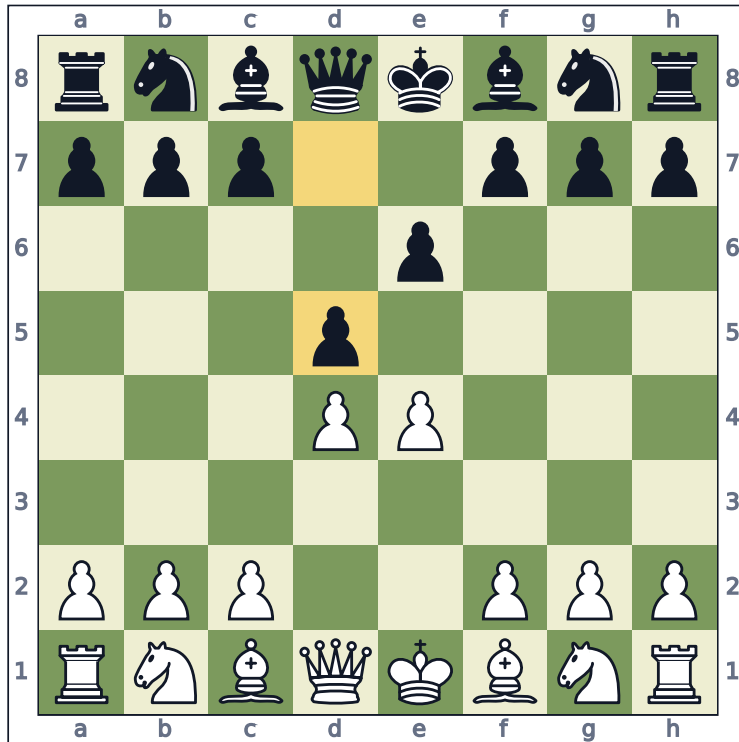


FRENCH DEFENSE

French Defense and Early e4-e6 Deviations

ECO C00 | 43 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.27 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C00 covers French Defense and Early e4-e6 Deviations. Black builds a d5-e6 center and accepts a temporarily restricted c8 bishop in exchange for a clear attack on White's center. The diagram uses the featured line French Defense.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the space advantage, support the e5 chain when it exists, and develop before beginning a kingside attack.

BLACK'S GOALS

Challenge d4 with ...c5, attack e5 with ...f6 when sound, and solve the c8 bishop deliberately.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

...c5 is the basic break; ...f6 is the second. White often uses c3, f4-f5, or queenside play depending on the structure.

PIECE MAP

White's e5 pawn can gain space but needs support. Black's bad bishop often becomes active after ...b6 and ...Ba6 or after exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Both sides can misjudge the pawn chain: attack its base and calculate breaks rather than attacking where the chain is strongest. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5, White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A sound, excellent defense with clear plans and rich counterplay, though cramped positions require patience.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C00 line

This section preserves all 43 names and defining routes assigned to C00 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 French Defense

1. e4 e6

002 French Defense

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5

003 French Defense: Alapin Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Be3

004 French Defense: Baeuerle Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 b5

005 French Defense: Banzai-Leong Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. b4

006 French Defense: Banzai-Leong Gambit, Pinova Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. b4 Bxb4 3. e5

007 French Defense: Bird Invitation

1. e4 e6 2. Bb5

008 French Defense: Carlson Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nf3 dxe4 4. Ne5

009 French Defense: Chigorin Variation

1. e4 e6 2. Qe2

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

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010 French Defense: Diemer-Duhm Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. c4

011 French Defense: Diemer-Duhm Gambit Accepted

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. c4 dxe4

012 French Defense: Franco-Hiva Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 f5

013 French Defense: Franco-Hiva Gambit Accepted

1. e4 e6 2. d4 f5 3. exf5

014 French Defense: Franco-Sicilian Defense

1. e4 e6 2. d4 c5

015 French Defense: Hoffmann Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Qe2 e5 4. f4 exf4

016 French Defense: Horwitz Attack

1. e4 e6 2. b3

017 French Defense: Horwitz Attack, Papa-Ticulat Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. b3 d5 3. Bb2

018 French Defense: King's Indian Attack

1. e4 e6 2. d3

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C00 line

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019 **French Defense: King's Indian Attack, Franco-Hiva Gambit**
1. e4 e6 2. d3 f5

020 **French Defense: Knight Variation**
1. e4 e6 2. Nf3

021 **French Defense: Knight Variation, Franco-Hiva Gambit**
1. e4 e6 2. Nf3 f5

022 **French Defense: La Bourdonnais Variation**
1. e4 e6 2. f4

023 **French Defense: La Bourdonnais Variation, Reuter Gambit**
1. e4 e6 2. f4 d5 3. Nf3 dxe4

024 **French Defense: Mediterranean Defense**
1. e4 e6 2. d4 Nf6

025 **French Defense: Morphy Gambit**
1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nh3

026 **French Defense: Normal Variation**
1. e4 e6 2. d4

027 **French Defense: Orthoschnapp Gambit**
1. e4 e6 2. c4 d5 3. cxd5 exd5 4. Qb3

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C00 line

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028 French Defense: Pelikan Variation

1. e4 e6 2. Nc3 d5 3. f4

029 French Defense: Perseus Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Nf3

030 French Defense: Queen's Knight

1. e4 e6 2. Nc3

031 French Defense: Reversed Philidor Formation

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Nc6 5. Be2

032 French Defense: Réti-Spielmann Attack

1. e4 e6 2. g3

033 French Defense: Schlechter Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. Bd3

034 French Defense: St. George Defense

1. e4 e6 2. d4 a6

035 French Defense: St. George Defense, Sanky-George Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 a6 3. c4 b5

036 French Defense: St. George Defense, St. George Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 a6 3. c4 b5 4. cxb5 axb5

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C00 line

This section preserves all 43 names and defining routes assigned to C00 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

037 French Defense: St. George Defense, Three Pawn Attack

1. e4 e6 2. d4 a6 3. c4

038 French Defense: St. George Defense, Traditional Line

1. e4 e6 2. d4 a6 3. Nf3 b5 4. Bd3 c5 5. c3 Bb7 6. O-O Nf6

039 French Defense: Steiner Variation

1. e4 e6 2. c4

040 French Defense: Steinitz Attack

1. e4 e6 2. e5

041 French Defense: Two Knights Variation

1. e4 e6 2. Nf3 d5 3. Nc3

042 French Defense: Wing Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. Nf3 d5 3. e5 c5 4. b4

043 Rat Defense: Small Center Defense

1. d4 e6 2. e4 d6